BUILD YOUR OWN WEBSITE WITH AI

No coding. Five steps, one afternoon, and it can cost nothing. This is how the class website was made.

STEP 1

GATHER YOUR INGREDIENTS

A brief

One page on who the site is for and how it should look and sound. Next slide.

Real content

Your resume, bio, project write-ups, photos. Real material in, real site out.

A sample of your voice

One paragraph you wrote and like. It teaches tone better than adjectives.

Rules you can check

"Alt text on every image." "Text at least 12 point." "High contrast."

An AI tool

Claude or ChatGPT in a browser works. Claude Code, Cowork or Codex can also make the files and publish them for you.

A GitHub account

Free at github.com. This is where the site will live.

STEP 2

WRITE A ONE-PAGE BRIEF

ANSWER FIVE QUESTIONS

Who is it for? One audience, named.

What is the personality? One word if you can.

What should it look like? Give it a picture, not a mood.

How should it sound? Two adjectives and a sample.

What must it include? Pages, links, accessibility rules.

OURS, FOR THE CLASS SITE

For: prospective arts management students

Personality: excitement

Look: an underground art event, like a flyer someone taped to a lamppost

Sound: warm and witty

Must have: alt text, 12 point or larger, high contrast, a link to our playlist

STEP 3

ASK FOR IT, THEN PUSH BACK

COPY THIS PROMPT

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Build a personal website for me. Below are two
things: a brief describing the audience, look and
tone, and my real content.

Use only facts from my content. Do not invent
anything. Follow every rule in the brief.

Make it a small multi-page site of plain HTML and
CSS files that I can host on GitHub Pages.

When you finish, tell me anything you guessed or
were unsure about.

[paste your brief]   [paste your content]
```

THEN ITERATE

Say what to keep. "The vibe is great."

Say what to change. "Make it feel like a place to visit, not one long page."

Feelings count. You do not need technical words.

Expect two or three rounds. The first draft is a draft.

STEP 4

CHECK IT LIKE AN EDITOR

Facts

Every name, date and number. The AI can be confidently wrong.

Links

Click each one yourself.

Voice

Rewrite any line that does not sound like you.

Accessibility

Run the page through wave.webaim.org. Try it with only a keyboard.

Permission

Anyone named or pictured should know they are on a public page.

Honesty

Decide whether and how you say AI helped build it.

The AI does the typing. You do the deciding.

STEP 5

PUT IT ONLINE, FREE

GITHUB PAGES, IN FIVE CLICKS

1. Sign in at github.com and click New repository. Name it, set it to Public, create it.

2. Click "uploading an existing file" and drag in all your site files. Commit.

3. Open Settings, then Pages.

4. Choose Deploy from a branch, pick main and / (root), and save.

5. Wait a minute. Your site is at yourname.github.io/your-repo-name.

OR LET THE AI DO IT

Claude Code, Cowork and Codex can connect to your GitHub account and upload the files for you. You still own the account and click the final switch.

To change the site later, upload a new copy of the file. It updates on its own.

OPTIONAL

WANT YOUR OWN ADDRESS?

YOURNAME.COM IN THREE MOVES

Buy the name. From a domain registrar such as Namecheap, Cloudflare or Squarespace Domains. Expect roughly $10 to $20 a year for a .com.

Point it at your site. In GitHub: Settings, Pages, Custom domain. At the registrar: add the DNS records GitHub lists.

Turn on HTTPS. Tick "Enforce HTTPS" once GitHub offers it.

ASK CLAUDE OR CODEX

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"I bought yourname.com at
[registrar]. My site is on GitHub
Pages at yourname.github.io/my-site.
Walk me through connecting them, one
step at a time, and tell me what each
DNS record does."
```

Other free hosts work the same way: Netlify and Cloudflare Pages both let you drag a folder in and attach a domain.

Prices and menus change. If a step looks different, paste a screenshot and ask.